

THE EXAMINER'S BENCH

Bench Status Pad Field Test

Test whether a 4 x 6 sheet can preserve the active state of an examination without becoming another record to maintain.

THE TEST

Complete the sheet at the end of a realistic work session. Put it out of sight. Return later and measure whether the next action becomes clear in under thirty seconds.

Before you print

- [] Use the exact-size 4 x 6 PDF for a real scale test.
- [] Use the letter two-up PDF when your printer cannot feed 4 x 6 stock.
- [] Print at 100 percent or Actual Size. Disable Fit, Shrink, or Scale to Page.
- [] Use fictitious or sanitized case information for testing.
- [] Do not treat the proof as an approved agency form or official examination note.

A useful scenario

Pause during an acquisition, review, or verification step that has a clear current state, a recent completed action, and one unresolved question. Fill the sheet with normal handwriting while you are genuinely ready to leave the bench.

Run the return test

- [] Wait at least two hours. Overnight or a weekend is better.
- [] Start a timer before reading the sheet.
- [] Stop when you can state the current process, last completed action, next action, and blocker.
- [] Record the time. Under thirty seconds is the design target.
- [] Mark any field you skipped, misunderstood, or wished had more room.

Evaluation sheet

Score the proof after a real interruption. A neat page is not the goal. Fast, accurate re-entry is.

TEST	NOTES	1-5
Speed How quickly did the case state return? Record the measured time.		
Clarity Did the fields capture the information you actually needed?		
Writing room Was 4 x 6 large enough with normal handwriting?		
Friction Could the sheet be completed while you were ready to leave?		
State markers Did Running, Safe to resume, and Blocked help or distract?		
Disposal cue Was the temporary-record reminder clear without dominating the page?		

What should change?

Remove or rename:

Add or enlarge:

The one field that earned its space:

Measured return time: seconds

Overall verdict: ☐ Ready for another test ☐ Revise first ☐ Wrong format